MEGA CHEATSHEET

The most comprehensive reference for OpenClaw operators and developers

v2026.4.1 · Updated Apr 1, 2026 · openclawcheatsheet.com

```
v2026.4.1 — /tasks board, SearXNG web_search, Bedrock Guardrails, cron --tools allowlists, agents.defaults.params, rate-limit failover.
v2026.3.31 — openclaw flows list|show|cancel, unified SQLite task ledger, QQ Bot channel, Matrix/MCP remote, install fail-closed; breaking:
nodes.run → exec host=node.
v2026.3.28 — openclaw config schema, Qwen Model Studio key, xAI Responses + x_search, MiniMax images, plugin approval hooks.
```

Core CLI — Setup & Channels

`openclaw gateway`	Run WebSocket Gateway server --port --bind --token
`openclaw gateway start|stop|restart`	Manage Gateway (launchd/systemd)
`openclaw channels login`	WhatsApp QR pairing (Web flow)
`openclaw channels add`	Add Telegram/Discord/Slack bot --token
`openclaw channels logs`	Show channel logs --channel
`openclaw channels remove`	Remove channel --channel --delete
`openclaw channels status --probe`	Check channel health
`openclaw onboard`	Interactive setup wizard --install-daemon
`openclaw doctor`	Health checks + quick fixes --deep --yes
`openclaw config file|get|set|unset|validate|schema`	Config path, edits, validate, print JSON Schema (schema: v2026.3.28+)

Core CLI — Models & Memory

`openclaw models list|set|status`	Model management + auth status
`openclaw models auth setup-token`	Preferred Anthropic auth flow
`openclaw models fallbacks add|remove`	Configure fallback chain
`openclaw memory status|index|search`	Vector search over MEMORY.md + logs
`openclaw agents list|add|delete`	Multi-agent workspace management
`openclaw agents bindings|bind|unbind`	Route bindings

Core CLI — Status & Tools

`openclaw logs --follow`	Tail Gateway file logs
`openclaw status --all --deep`	Full diagnosis (pasteable) --usage
`openclaw sessions --json`	List stored sessions
`openclaw security audit`	Audit config for security issues --fix
`openclaw browser start|tabs|screenshot`	Headless browser automation
`openclaw cron list|add|edit|rm|enable|disable|run`	Scheduled jobs; add/edit supports --tools allowlists (v2026.4.1) --tools
`openclaw flows list|show|cancel`	Linear task flows (unified ledger; v2026.3.31)
`openclaw pairing list|approve`	Approve DM pairing requests
`openclaw reset --scope`	Reset config/creds/sessions/full

Global Flags

`--dev`	Isolate state under ~/.openclaw-dev
`--profile <name>`	Isolate under ~/.openclaw-<name>

`--no-color`	Disable ANSI colors (NO_COLOR=1)
`-V, --version`	Print version and exit

🛠️ Power Commands

`openclaw plugins list|info|enable|disable|install|doctor`	Manage plugin lifecycle
`openclaw skills list|info|check|search|install|update`	Skills (v2026.3.22+: search|install|update)
`openclaw approvals get|set|allowlist`	Exec approval policy
`openclaw sandbox list|recreate|explain`	Inspect/rebuild sandbox
`openclaw system event --text "X"`	Queue system event
`openclaw system heartbeat enable|disable|last`	Control heartbeat
`openclaw update status|wizard`	Manage release channel
`openclaw backup create|verify`	Local state archive --only-config --no-include-workspace
`openclaw health --json --verbose`	Direct gateway health probe
`openclaw dashboard`	Open Control UI
`openclaw tui --url --token`	Remote-safe terminal UI

🚀 Quick Start & Install

Global Install

```
npm install -g openclaw@latest
```

Onboarding

1. `openclaw onboard --install-daemon` — Guided setup
2. `openclaw channels login` — Channel link
3. `openclaw gateway --port 18789` — Start gateway

One-liner

```
curl -fsSL https://openclaw.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Channel Setup

WhatsApp	QR Scan	`openclaw channels login`
Telegram	Bot Token	`channels add --channel telegram --token $TOKEN`
Discord	Bot Token	`channels add --channel discord --token $TOKEN`
Slack	Bot Token	`channels add --channel slack`
Google Chat	Service Account	`channels add --channel googlechat`
WebChat	Built-in	`localhost:18789`

Status: `openclaw channels status --probe`. Discord: `autoArchiveDuration` (60|1440|4320|10080) for thread archiving.

Workspace Files

Root: ~/.openclaw/workspace

`AGENTS.md`	Operating instructions for the agent
`SOUL.md`	Persona, tone, boundaries
`USER.md`	User info & preferences
`IDENTITY.md`	Agent name, emoji, theme
`MEMORY.md`	Long-term memory (DM only)
`memory/YYYY-MM-DD.md`	Daily append-only log
`TOOLS.md`	Local tool notes
`HEARTBEAT.md`	Heartbeat checklist
`BOOT.md`	Startup checklist

Memory System

Daily Logs `memory/YYYY-MM-DD.md` — today + yesterday

Long-Term `MEMORY.md` — curated, DM only

Vector Search — ~400 token chunks

Providers — local GGUF → OpenAI → Gemini (incl. gemini-embedding-2-preview) → Ollama → Voyage

`openclaw memory index --all`	Reindex
`openclaw memory search "X"`	Query

Models & Auth

`openclaw models list --all`	View available models
`openclaw models set <model>`	Set agents.defaults.model.primary
`openclaw models auth setup-token`	Preferred Anthropic auth
`openclaw models auth add --provider <p>`	Add provider API key
`openclaw models status --probe`	Live probe auth

Probe consumes tokens — use status --deep for diagnostics

Sessions

`session.dmScope` — main | per-peer | per-channel-peer | per-account-channel-peer

`session.reset.mode` — daily (4am) | idle

`session.reset.idleMinutes` — Sliding idle window

`session.store` — ~/.openclaw/agents/<id>/sessions/

SECURITY: Use per-channel-peer for multi-user inboxes to prevent context leakage.

Slash Commands

`/status`	Session health + context; provider usage
`/tasks`	Background task board for session (v2026.4.1)
`/help, /commands`	Common commands
`/context list|detail|json`	Context window contents
`/model [id]|list|status`	Switch model
`/usage off|tokens|full|cost`	Per-response footer
`/fast`	Toggle fast mode (Anthropic/OpenAI) v2026.3.12
`/compact [instr]`	Summarize context, free tokens
`/new [model]`	Fresh session (alias: /reset)
`/stop`	Abort run + clear queue
`/send on|off|inherit`	Override delivery
`/tts on|off|always|inbound`	Text-to-speech
`/think [level]`	Reasoning: off|minimal|low|medium|high|xhigh|adaptive
`/reasoning, /elevated`	Reasoning level; exec approval
`/whoami`	Sender identity (/id)
`/subagents spawn|list|kill|steer`	Sub-agent control
`/export-session`	Export session to HTML
`/approve allow-once|deny`	Exec + plugin approvals (v2026.3.28+)
`/check-updates`	Quick update summary

Text-to-Speech

Provider	Quality	Cost
ElevenLabs	Ultra-realistic	Premium
OpenAI TTS	Fast, high-quality	Standard
Edge TTS	Multi-language	Free
Mistral Voice	Provider support	Standard

Auto-TTS: `messages.tts.auto: "always"`

Logging & Diagnostics

`openclaw logs --follow`	Tail Gateway logs
`openclaw logs --json --limit 200`	Line-delimited JSON
`openclaw status --all --deep`	Full diagnosis --usage
`openclaw doctor --deep --yes`	Health check + auto-fix
`openclaw channels logs --channel [id]`	Channel-specific logs

Browser & Cron

Browser

`openclaw browser start|stop|tabs`	Headless instance
`openclaw browser open <url>`	Open URL
`openclaw browser screenshot`	Capture view
`openclaw browser pdf`	Export page as PDF

Cron

`openclaw cron list|add|edit|rm|enable|disable|run`	Scheduled jobs; use --tools on add|edit for allowlists (v2026.4.1). See also openclaw flows. --tools

```
{ "name": "Brief", "schedule": { "kind": "cron", "expr": "0 8 * * *" }, "sessionTarget": "isolated" }
```

v2026.3.11: Isolated cron no longer notifies via ad hoc agent sends. Run `openclaw doctor --fix` to migrate legacy cron.

Hooks & Automation

`session-memory` command:new — Save context on /new

`boot-md` gateway:startup — Run BOOT.md on start

`openclaw hooks list|enable|disable`	Manage hooks

Skills

Precedence

1 workspace/skills/ (highest) · 2 ~/.openclaw/skills/ · 3 Bundled

`openclaw skills list|info|check|search|install|update`	Bundled + managed (v2026.3.22+: search|install|update)
`clawhub install <slug>`	ClawHub
`clawhub update --all`	Update installed skills

```
---
name: my-skill
description: "What it does"
metadata: { "openclaw": { "requires": { ... } } }
---
```

👥 Multi-Agent Routing

Precedence: peer → guildId → teamId → accountId → channel → default

`openclaw agents add <name>`	Add agent
`openclaw agents list --bindings`	View bindings

🎯 Sub-Agents

Run research without blocking. Own session + optional sandbox. Auto-announce results.

`/subagents spawn`	Spawn sub-agent from chat
`/subagents list|kill|steer|send`	Control sub-agents

📂 Key Paths

`~/.openclaw/openclaw.json` — Main config

`~/.openclaw/workspace/` — Agent workspace

`~/.openclaw/agents/<id>/sessions/` — Session store

`~/.openclaw/credentials/` — OAuth/API keys

`~/.openclaw/memory/<id>.sqlite` — Vector index

`/tmp/openclaw/openclaw-YYYY-MM-DD.log` — Gateway log

Use --dev or --profile for isolated state

💗 Heartbeat

`heartbeat.every` — 30m default (1h OAuth)

`heartbeat.target` — last | none | <id>

`heartbeat.model` — Override for heartbeat

`heartbeat.activeHours` — Time window

Reply HEARTBEAT_OK if nothing needs attention. Agent strips OK-only.

🔧 Troubleshooting

No DM Reply `openclaw pairing list → approve`

Context Full `/compact or /new`

Channel Down `openclaw channels status --probe`

Auth Expired `openclaw models auth setup-token --provider anthropic`

Auth/Pairing Fails (v2026.3.7+) `gateway.auth.mode: token|password`

Cron Notify Broken (v2026.3.11) `openclaw doctor --fix`

Workspace Plugins Not Loading (v2026.3.12) `Auto-load disabled — explicit trust required`

Memory Not Indexing `openclaw memory index`

Config Invalid `openclaw config validate`

Universal Fix: `openclaw doctor --deep --yes`

🔐 Sandboxing

`sandbox.mode` — off | non-main (default) | all

`sandbox.scope` — session | agent | shared

`workspaceAccess` — none | ro | rw

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